

COMPLETE INDIAN DIET GUIDE

Weight Loss | Muscle Gain | Weight Maintenance

Vegetarian & Non-Vegetarian Meal Plans

Breakfast | Lunch | Dinner | Snacks — With Alternatives

Traditional Indian Cuisine | Macro-Balanced | Ingredient-Listed

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This guide is designed to help you choose meals based on your fitness goal. Each section contains four meal types: **Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner, and Snacks**. For each meal, multiple options are provided so you can rotate based on preference, availability, and taste. Every dish includes a complete ingredient list and approximate calorie guidance.

Key:

- **Green labels** = Vegetarian options
- **Red labels** = Non-Vegetarian options
- **Calorie ranges** are per serving and approximate
- **Alternatives** are provided within each meal category

Note: Portion sizes should be adjusted based on your body weight, activity level, and metabolic rate. Consult a registered dietitian for personalized medical nutrition therapy.

SECTION 1: WEIGHT LOSS / FAT LOSS

This plan focuses on a **calorie deficit** with high protein and fiber to preserve muscle and keep you satiated. Typical daily target: **1,400–1,800 kcal** depending on body size and activity.

VEGETARIAN — BREAKFAST OPTIONS

Option A: Moong Dal Chilla (2 pieces) + Green Chutney (~280 kcal)

Ingredients: Split moong dal (soaked & ground, 1 cup), besan (2 tbsp), ginger, green chili, turmeric, cumin, coriander leaves, salt, oil (1 tsp). Chutney: mint, coriander, green chili, lemon, salt.

Tip: High protein, low GI. Keeps you full for 3–4 hours.

Option B: Oats Upma (1 bowl) + Black Coffee (~250 kcal)

Ingredients: Rolled oats (1/2 cup dry), mustard seeds, curry leaves, onion, green chili, turmeric, peas, carrot, salt, oil (1 tsp). Coffee: black, no sugar.

Tip: Fiber-rich complex carbs. Avoid instant oats with added sugar.

Option C: Sprout Salad Bowl (1 bowl) + Lemon Water (~220 kcal)

Ingredients: Mixed sprouts (moong, chana, matki — 1.5 cups), onion, tomato, cucumber, chaat masala, lemon juice, black salt, green chili, coriander.

Tip: Live enzymes and high fiber. Excellent for gut health.

Option D: Poha (1 plate) with Peanuts & Veggies (~300 kcal)

Ingredients: Flattened rice (1 cup dry), peanuts (1 tbsp), mustard seeds, curry leaves, onion, potato (small), green peas, turmeric, lemon, salt, oil (1 tsp).

Tip: Light yet satisfying. Add extra veggies to increase volume without calories.

NON-VEGETARIAN — BREAKFAST OPTIONS

Option A: Egg White Bhurji (3 whites + 1 whole egg) + 2 Multigrain Toast (~320 kcal)

Ingredients: Egg whites (3), whole egg (1), onion, tomato, green chili, turmeric, coriander, salt, oil (1 tsp). Bread: multigrain (2 slices), butter (optional, 1/2 tsp).

Tip: High protein, low fat. Use minimal oil.

Option B: Chicken Seekh Kebab (2 pieces) + Mint Raita (~350 kcal)

Ingredients: Minced chicken breast (150g), onion, ginger-garlic paste, green chili, garam masala, coriander, salt, lemon. Raita: low-fat curd (1/2 cup), mint, roasted cumin, salt.

Tip: Grill or air-fry instead of frying. Lean protein source.

Option C: Masala Omelette (2 eggs) + Sautéed Spinach (~300 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole eggs (2), onion, tomato, green chili, turmeric, coriander, salt, oil (1 tsp). Spinach (1 cup), garlic, salt.

Tip: Eggs provide complete amino acid profile. Spinach adds iron and fiber.

Option D: Tandoori Fish Tikka (100g) + Cucumber Salad (~280 kcal)

Ingredients: Fish (rohu/tilapia/salmon, 100g), ginger-garlic paste, turmeric, red chili powder, lemon, salt, mustard oil (1 tsp). Salad: cucumber, onion, tomato, lemon, black salt.

Tip: Omega-3 rich if using salmon. Grilled, not fried.

VEGETARIAN — LUNCH OPTIONS

Option A: 2 Bajra/Multigrain Roti + Dal Palak + Cucumber Raita (~450 kcal)

Ingredients: Bajra/multigrain flour (for 2 rotis), toor dal (1/2 cup cooked), spinach (1 cup), onion, tomato, turmeric, cumin, garlic, salt, oil (1 tsp). Raita: low-fat curd (1/2 cup), cucumber, roasted cumin, salt.

Tip: Bajra is gluten-free and thermogenic. Dal provides slow-releasing protein.

Option B: Brown Rice (1/2 cup) + Rajma Masala + Mixed Veg Salad (~480 kcal)

Ingredients: Brown rice (1/2 cup cooked), rajma (kidney beans, 3/4 cup cooked), onion, tomato, ginger-garlic, cumin, coriander powder, garam masala, salt, oil (1 tsp). Salad: cabbage, carrot, lemon.

Tip: Rajma is fiber-dense. Brown rice has more satiety than white rice.

Option C: 2 Jowar Roti + Lauki/Dudhi Sabzi + Buttermilk (~380 kcal)

Ingredients: Jowar flour (for 2 rotis), bottle gourd (1.5 cups), onion, tomato, turmeric, cumin, mustard seeds, curry leaves, salt, oil (1 tsp). Buttermilk: thin curd (1 cup), roasted cumin, salt, curry leaves.

Tip: Lauki is 96% water — excellent for hydration and low calories.

Option D: Quinoa Pulao (1 cup) + Paneer Tikka (100g) + Green Salad (~520 kcal)

Ingredients: Quinoa (1/2 cup dry), mixed vegetables (peas, carrot, beans), onion, bay leaf, cinnamon, salt, oil (1 tsp). Paneer (100g), yogurt marinade (1 tbsp), turmeric, red chili, lemon. Salad: lettuce, cucumber, lemon.

Tip: Quinoa is a complete protein grain. Paneer adds casein protein for satiety.

NON-VEGETARIAN — LUNCH OPTIONS

Option A: 2 Whole Wheat Roti + Chicken Curry (150g) + Cabbage Sabzi (~520 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (2 rotis), chicken breast (150g), onion, tomato, ginger-garlic, turmeric, coriander, cumin, garam masala, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Cabbage (1 cup), mustard seeds, turmeric, salt.

Tip: Chicken breast is one of the leanest protein sources. Use minimal oil in curry.

Option B: Brown Rice (1/2 cup) + Fish Curry (150g) + Stir-Fried Beans (~480 kcal)

Ingredients: Brown rice (1/2 cup cooked), fish (rohu/katla/tilapia, 150g), mustard seeds, curry leaves, onion, tomato, turmeric, red chili, tamarind, salt, mustard oil (1 tsp). French beans (1 cup), garlic, salt.

Tip: Fish is easily digestible protein. Mustard oil adds healthy omega fats.

Option C: 2 Ragi Roti + Egg Curry (2 whole eggs) + Tomato-Onion Salad (~460 kcal)

Ingredients: Ragi flour (2 rotis), whole eggs (2), onion, tomato, ginger-garlic, turmeric, coriander, cumin, salt, oil (1 tsp). Salad: tomato, onion, lemon, black salt, green chili.

Tip: Ragi is calcium-rich and has a low glycemic index. Eggs provide vitamin D and B12.

Option D: Chicken Biryani (1 cup, oil-reduced) + Cucumber Raita + Boiled Egg (1) (~580 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (1/3 cup raw), chicken (100g), onion, tomato, yogurt (1 tbsp), biryani masala, saffron, mint, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Raita: curd (1/2 cup), cucumber, cumin. Egg (1 whole, boiled).

Tip: Use less oil and more yogurt marinade for moisture. Remove chicken skin.

VEGETARIAN — DINNER OPTIONS

Option A: Grilled Paneer Salad Bowl (150g paneer) + Soup (~380 kcal)

Ingredients: Paneer (150g), bell peppers, onion, zucchini, olive oil (1 tsp), oregano, salt, pepper. Soup: mixed vegetable clear soup (tomato, carrot, beans, salt, pepper).

Tip: Keep dinner light and protein-focused. Avoid heavy carbs at night.

Option B: 1 Missi Roti + Methi Sabzi + Dal (thin consistency) (~350 kcal)

Ingredients: Missi roti (besan + wheat flour, 1 roti), methi leaves (1 cup), onion, garlic, turmeric, cumin, salt, oil (1 tsp). Toor dal (thin, 1 cup), turmeric, salt, hing.

Tip: Methi helps regulate blood sugar. Light dal aids digestion before sleep.

Option C: Stir-Fried Tofu (150g) + Broccoli & Mushroom + Clear Soup (~320 kcal)

Ingredients: Tofu (150g), broccoli (1 cup), mushrooms (1/2 cup), soy sauce (low sodium, 1 tsp), garlic, ginger, sesame oil (1/2 tsp), pepper. Soup: vegetable clear soup.

Tip: Tofu is a complete plant protein. Broccoli is rich in vitamin C and fiber.

Option D: Vegetable Khichdi (1 bowl) + Curd (1/2 cup) + Pickle (1 tsp) (~340 kcal)

Ingredients: Moong dal (1/3 cup), brown rice (1/4 cup), mixed vegetables (carrot, beans, peas), turmeric, cumin, ginger, salt, ghee (1/2 tsp). Curd: low-fat (1/2 cup).

Tip: Khichdi is easy to digest. Ideal for dinner when you want a comforting meal.

NON-VEGETARIAN — DINNER OPTIONS

Option A: Grilled Chicken Breast (150g) + Sautéed Vegetables + Clear Soup (~420 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken breast (150g), lemon juice, black pepper, garlic, salt, olive oil (1 tsp). Vegetables: bell peppers, zucchini, mushrooms, salt, pepper. Soup: chicken/vegetable clear soup.

Tip: Grilled chicken is the gold standard for fat-loss dinners. High protein, minimal fat.

Option B: Fish Tikka (150g) + Cauliflower Rice (1 cup) + Raita (~380 kcal)

Ingredients: Fish (150g), yogurt marinade (1 tbsp), turmeric, red chili, lemon, salt. Cauliflower rice (1 cup grated, sautéed with cumin, salt). Raita: cucumber, cumin, curd (1/2 cup).

Tip: Cauliflower rice slashes carb intake while keeping volume high.

Option C: Egg Drop Soup (2 eggs) + Stir-Fried Chicken (100g) + Side Salad (~360 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken stock (2 cups), eggs (2 whisked), corn (1 tsp, optional), soy sauce (low sodium), vinegar, pepper, spring onion. Chicken (100g) stir-fried with garlic, ginger, salt. Salad: lettuce, cucumber, lemon.

Tip: Light yet protein-dense. Perfect for late dinners.

Option D: Mutton/Chicken Soup (1 bowl) + 1 Multigrain Toast + Green Salad (~400 kcal)

Ingredients: Mutton/chicken bone broth (1 bowl), onion, ginger-garlic, turmeric, salt, pepper. Toast: multigrain (1 slice). Salad: cucumber, lettuce, lemon, black pepper.

Tip: Bone broth is rich in collagen and minerals. Very light on the stomach.

SECTION 2: WEIGHT MAINTENANCE

This plan is designed for **caloric equilibrium** — eating enough to sustain your current weight while optimizing micronutrient intake. Typical daily target: **1,800–2,400 kcal** based on activity level.

VEGETARIAN — BREAKFAST OPTIONS

Option A: Idli (3) + Sambar (1 cup) + Coconut Chutney (2 tbsp) (~420 kcal)

Ingredients: Idli batter (rice + urad dal, 3 idlis), sambar (toor dal, vegetables, tamarind, sambar powder, salt), coconut chutney (fresh coconut, green chili, curry leaves, mustard, salt).

Tip: Fermented batter is probiotic-rich. Sambar provides lentils and vegetables.

Option B: Aloo Paratha (1) + Curd (1 cup) + Pickle (~480 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat dough (1 paratha), potato filling (boiled potato, cumin, coriander, green chili, salt), ghee (1 tsp). Curd (1 cup). Pickle (1 tsp).

Tip: Use minimal ghee. Whole wheat provides complex carbs for sustained energy.

Option C: Masala Dosa (1) + Sambar + Chutney (~450 kcal)

Ingredients: Dosa batter (rice + urad dal, 1 dosa), potato masala (onion, mustard, turmeric, salt), sambar (1 cup), coconut chutney (2 tbsp).

Tip: Fermented food aids digestion. Potato filling provides potassium.

Option D: Vegetable Daliya (1 bowl) + Milk (1 glass) + Almonds (5) (~460 kcal)

Ingredients: Broken wheat/daliya (1/2 cup dry), mixed vegetables (peas, carrot, beans), onion, turmeric, salt, ghee (1 tsp). Milk (1 glass, toned). Almonds (5 pieces).

Tip: Daliya is high in fiber. Almonds add vitamin E and healthy fats.

NON-VEGETARIAN — BREAKFAST OPTIONS

Option A: Chicken Kathi Roll (1) + Green Chutney (~480 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat paratha (1), chicken strips (100g), onion, capsicum, ginger-garlic, turmeric, garam masala, salt, oil (1 tsp). Chutney: mint, coriander, green chili, lemon.

Tip: A complete meal on-the-go. Use whole wheat paratha for better fiber.

Option B: Egg Paratha (2 eggs) + Curd + Fruit (~520 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat paratha (1), eggs (2), onion, green chili, turmeric, coriander, salt, oil (1 tsp). Curd (1 cup). Fruit: apple or orange (1 medium).

Tip: Eggs provide choline for brain health. Fruit adds natural sugars and fiber.

Option C: Keema Paratha (100g mutton/chicken keema) + Raita (~580 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat paratha (1), minced meat (100g), onion, ginger-garlic, green peas, garam masala, turmeric, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Raita: curd (1/2 cup), cucumber, cumin.

Tip: Keema is iron-rich. Pair with raita to balance spice and add probiotics.

Option D: Fish Cutlet (2 pieces) + Bread (2 slices) + Tomato Salad (~500 kcal)

Ingredients: Fish (150g, mashed), potato (1 small, boiled), onion, green chili, turmeric, breadcrumbs, egg (1, for binding), salt, oil (for shallow fry, 1.5 tsp). Bread (2 slices). Salad: tomato, onion, lemon.

Tip: Shallow fry instead of deep fry. Use minimal potato as binder.

VEGETARIAN — LUNCH OPTIONS

Option A: 3 Chapati + Paneer Butter Masala (150g) + Jeera Rice (1/2 cup) + Salad (~720 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (3 chapatis), paneer (150g), onion, tomato, cashew paste (1 tbsp), cream (1 tbsp), butter (1 tsp), garam masala, kasuri methi, salt. Rice: basmati (1/2 cup cooked), cumin, ghee (1/2 tsp). Salad: onion, cucumber, lemon.

Tip: Paneer provides casein protein. Use cashew paste instead of heavy cream for a healthier gravy.

Option B: 2 Roti + Chana Masala (1 cup) + Rice (1/2 cup) + Pickle + Buttermilk (~680 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (2 rotis), chickpeas (1 cup cooked), onion, tomato, ginger-garlic, amchur, garam masala, turmeric, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Rice (1/2 cup). Buttermilk (1 cup). Pickle (1 tsp).

Tip: Chana is high in protein and iron. Amchur adds vitamin C which aids iron absorption.

Option C: Vegetable Biryani (1 cup) + Raita (1 cup) + Papad (1) (~650 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (1/2 cup raw), mixed vegetables (carrot, beans, peas, cauliflower), onion, yogurt (2 tbsp), biryani masala, mint, saffron, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Raita: curd (1 cup), onion, cucumber, cumin, salt. Papad (1, roasted).

Tip: Roast papad instead of frying. Use plenty of vegetables to increase fiber.

Option D: 2 Roti + Palak Paneer (1 cup) + Dal Makhani (1/2 cup) + Salad (~700 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (2 rotis), spinach (2 cups), paneer (100g), onion, tomato, cream (1 tbsp), garam masala, salt, butter (1 tsp). Dal makhani: black urad + rajma (1/2 cup), butter (1 tsp), cream (1 tsp). Salad: cucumber, tomato, lemon.

Tip: Palak is iron-rich. Dal makhani is calorie-dense; keep portion controlled.

NON-VEGETARIAN — LUNCH OPTIONS

Option A: 3 Roti + Butter Chicken (150g) + Steamed Rice (1/2 cup) + Salad (~780 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (3 rotis), chicken (150g), tomato puree, cashew paste (1 tbsp), cream (1 tbsp), butter (1 tsp), garam masala, kasuri methi, salt. Rice (1/2 cup). Salad: onion, cucumber, lemon.

Tip: Use chicken breast for leaner protein. Tomato puree provides lycopene.

Option B: Chicken Biryani (1.5 cups) + Raita + Boiled Egg (1) + Salad (~820 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (1/2 cup raw), chicken (150g), onion, yogurt (2 tbsp), biryani masala, mint, saffron, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Raita: curd (1 cup), cucumber, cumin. Egg (1). Salad: onion, tomato, lemon.

Tip: Biryani is a complete meal. Use yogurt marinade to tenderize chicken naturally.

Option C: 2 Roti + Mutton Rogan Josh (150g) + Steamed Rice (1/2 cup) + Veg Sabzi (~850 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (2 rotis), mutton (150g), onion, yogurt (2 tbsp), Kashmiri chili, fennel, ginger-garlic, garam masala, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Rice (1/2 cup). Veg sabzi: seasonal vegetable (1 cup), turmeric, salt, oil (1/2 tsp).

Tip: Mutton is rich in B12 and zinc. Kashmiri chili adds color without excessive heat.

Option D: Fish Curry (200g) + Brown Rice (1 cup) + Bhindi Sabzi + Buttermilk (~720 kcal)

Ingredients: Fish (200g), mustard seeds, curry leaves, onion, tomato, turmeric, red chili, tamarind, salt, mustard oil (1.5 tsp). Brown rice (1 cup cooked). Bhindi (okra, 1 cup), onion, turmeric, salt, oil (1 tsp). Buttermilk (1 cup).

Tip: Mustard oil and fish are a classic combination. Okra provides soluble fiber.

VEGETARIAN — DINNER OPTIONS

Option A: 2 Roti + Mixed Vegetable Curry (1 cup) + Dal (1 cup) + Salad (~580 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (2 rotis), mixed vegetables (cauliflower, carrot, beans, peas, 1.5 cups), onion, tomato, turmeric, cumin, coriander, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Toor dal (1 cup), turmeric, salt, hing. Salad: cucumber, tomato, lemon.

Tip: Balanced and light. Mixed vegetables ensure diverse micronutrients.

Option B: Vegetable Pulao (1 cup) + Rajma (1/2 cup) + Curd (1 cup) + Papad (~620 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (1/3 cup raw), mixed vegetables, onion, bay leaf, cinnamon, salt, oil (1 tsp). Rajma (1/2 cup cooked), onion, tomato, spices, salt, oil (1/2 tsp). Curd (1 cup). Papad (1, roasted).

Tip: Pulao is lighter than biryani. Rajma adds plant protein and fiber.

Option C: Stuffed Tomato (2) with Paneer + 1 Roti + Soup (~520 kcal)

Ingredients: Tomatoes (2 large, hollowed), paneer stuffing (100g paneer, onion, coriander, cumin, salt), baked. Roti (1 whole wheat). Soup: mixed vegetable clear soup.

Tip: Baked, not fried. Tomatoes provide lycopene and vitamin C.

Option D: Moong Dal Khichdi (1.5 cups) + Ghee (1 tsp) + Curd + Pickle (~560 kcal)

Ingredients: Moong dal (1/2 cup), rice (1/4 cup), turmeric, cumin, ginger, salt, ghee (1 tsp). Curd (1 cup). Pickle (1 tsp).

Tip: Comfort food that is easy to digest. Ghee aids absorption of fat-soluble vitamins.

NON-VEGETARIAN — DINNER OPTIONS

Option A: Tandoori Chicken (200g) + 2 Roti + Dal (1 cup) + Salad (~680 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken (200g, leg/breast), yogurt marinade (2 tbsp), ginger-garlic, turmeric, red chili, garam masala, lemon, salt. Roti (2 whole wheat). Dal (1 cup, any variety). Salad: onion, cucumber, lemon.

Tip: Tandoori cooking uses minimal oil. Yogurt marinade keeps chicken moist.

Option B: Egg Curry (3 eggs) + 2 Roti + Steamed Rice (1/2 cup) + Cabbage Sabzi (~640 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole eggs (3, boiled), onion, tomato, ginger-garlic, turmeric, coriander, cumin, garam masala, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Roti (2). Rice (1/2 cup). Cabbage (1 cup), mustard seeds, turmeric, salt.

Tip: Eggs are budget-friendly complete protein. Cabbage is rich in vitamin K.

Option C: Grilled Fish (200g) + Sautéed Spinach + 1 Roti + Dal (~600 kcal)

Ingredients: Fish (200g), lemon, black pepper, turmeric, salt, mustard oil (1 tsp). Spinach (1.5 cups), garlic, salt. Roti (1). Dal (1 cup).

Tip: Light dinner option. Fish provides omega-3 and high-quality protein.

Option D: Chicken Soup (1 bowl) + Garlic Bread (2 slices) + Green Salad (~580 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken (100g, shredded), chicken stock, noodles (1/2 cup), carrot, beans, salt, pepper, garlic. Bread (2 slices multigrain), garlic butter (1 tsp). Salad: lettuce, cucumber, lemon, olive oil (1/2 tsp).

Tip: Soup is hydrating and filling. Use multigrain bread for extra fiber.

SECTION 3: MUSCLE GAIN / BULKING

This plan emphasizes a **calorie surplus** with high protein (1.6–2.2g per kg bodyweight) and complex carbohydrates to fuel training and recovery. Typical daily target: **2,500–3,500 kcal**.

VEGETARIAN — BREAKFAST OPTIONS

Option A: Paneer Paratha (2) + Curd (1.5 cups) + Banana Milkshake (~850 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (2 parathas), paneer (150g, grated, spiced), ghee (2 tsp). Curd (1.5 cups). Milkshake: full-fat milk (1 glass), banana (2), honey (1 tsp), almonds (5), dates (2).

Tip: Banana provides potassium and quick carbs. Paneer offers slow-digesting casein.

Option B: Moong Dal Cheela (3) + Stuffed Potato + Peanut Chutney (~780 kcal)

Ingredients: Moong dal (1.5 cups, soaked & ground), besan (3 tbsp), spices. Potato stuffing (2 medium, boiled, spiced). Peanut chutney: roasted peanuts (2 tbsp), garlic, green chili, salt.

Tip: Triple cheela serving for extra protein. Peanuts add healthy fats and calories.

Option C: Soya Chunk Upma (1.5 cups) + Milk (1 glass) + Walnuts (5) (~720 kcal)

Ingredients: Soya chunks (1 cup, rehydrated), semolina (1/2 cup), mustard, curry leaves, onion, green chili, turmeric, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Full-fat milk (1 glass). Walnuts (5 halves).

Tip: Soya chunks are one of the best plant protein sources. Walnuts add omega-3 ALA.

Option D: Oats Porridge (1.5 cups cooked) + Whey/Plant Protein (1 scoop) + Peanut Butter (1 tbsp) + Dates (3) (~800 kcal)

Ingredients: Rolled oats (3/4 cup dry), full-fat milk (1.5 cups), whey or plant protein (1 scoop), peanut butter (1 tbsp), dates (3), cinnamon, honey (optional, 1 tsp).

Tip: Protein powder bridges the protein gap. Peanut butter adds calorie density.

NON-VEGETARIAN — BREAKFAST OPTIONS

Option A: 4-Egg Omelette (2 whole + 4 whites) + 3 Toast + Avocado (1/2) + Milk (~820 kcal)

Ingredients: Eggs (2 whole, 4 whites), onion, tomato, green chili, turmeric, coriander, salt, butter (1 tsp). Bread (3 slices multigrain). Avocado (1/2 medium). Full-fat milk (1 glass).

Tip: Whole eggs provide fats and cholesterol for hormone production. Avocado adds monounsaturated fats.

Option B: Chicken Sandwich (200g chicken) + Cheese Slice + Mayo + Milkshake (~900 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken breast (200g, shredded/grilled), bread (4 slices), cheese slice (1), mayonnaise (1 tbsp), lettuce, tomato, onion. Milkshake: full-fat milk (1 glass), banana (1), protein powder (optional).

Tip: Cheese and mayo add calories for surplus. Use whole-grain bread for micronutrients.

Option C: Mutton Keema (200g) + 2 Paratha + Lassi (1 glass) (~950 kcal)

Ingredients: Minced mutton (200g), onion, ginger-garlic, green peas, garam masala, turmeric, salt, oil (2 tsp). Paratha (2 whole wheat), ghee (2 tsp). Lassi: full-fat curd (1.5 cups), sugar (1 tsp), water.

Tip: Mutton is calorie-dense and rich in creatine. Lassi aids digestion and adds protein.

Option D: Fish Fry (200g) + 2 Roti + Dal (1 cup) + Banana (2) (~880 kcal)

Ingredients: Fish (200g, rohu/katla/salmon), turmeric, red chili, salt, mustard oil (2 tsp). Roti (2 whole wheat). Dal (1 cup, any variety). Banana (2 medium).

Tip: Fish provides omega-3 and high biological value protein. Bananas add potassium and carbs.

VEGETARIAN — LUNCH OPTIONS

Option A: 4 Chapati + Paneer Tikka Masala (200g) + Jeera Rice (1 cup) + Dal (1 cup) + Salad (~1100 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (4 chapatis), paneer (200g), onion, tomato, cashew paste (2 tbsp), cream (2 tbsp), butter (1.5 tsp), spices. Rice (1 cup cooked), cumin, ghee (1 tsp). Dal (1 cup). Salad: cucumber, onion, lemon.

Tip: High volume meal. Paneer and dal together provide substantial protein.

Option B: 3 Paratha + Chole (1.5 cups) + Rice (1 cup) + Raita + Pickle + Papad (~1150 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (3 parathas), ghee (3 tsp). Chickpeas (1.5 cups cooked), onion, tomato, amchur, garam masala, spices, oil (2 tsp). Rice (1 cup). Raita (1 cup). Papad (2, roasted).

Tip: Chole is protein and fiber-rich. Parathas provide calorie-dense carbs.

Option C: Vegetable Biryani (2 cups) + Paneer Curry (150g) + Raita + Dessert (Kheer) (~1200 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (3/4 cup raw), mixed vegetables, onion, yogurt (3 tbsp), biryani masala, mint, saffron, oil (2 tsp). Paneer curry (150g paneer, onion, tomato, cream 1 tbsp, spices). Raita (1 cup). Kheer: rice (2 tbsp), milk (1 cup), sugar (1 tbsp),

nuts.

Tip: Dessert adds calories for surplus. Use full-fat milk throughout.

Option D: Rajma Chawal (1.5 cups each) + Aloo Gobi Sabzi + 2 Roti + Curd + Ghee (~1050 kcal)

Ingredients: Rajma (1.5 cups cooked), onion, tomato, spices, oil (1.5 tsp). Rice (1.5 cups cooked). Aloo gobi (potato 1 medium, cauliflower 1 cup, spices, oil 1 tsp). Roti (2). Curd (1.5 cups). Ghee (1 tsp on rice).

Tip: Rajma-rice is a complete protein combination. Ghee on rice adds healthy calories.

NON-VEGETARIAN — LUNCH OPTIONS

Option A: 4 Roti + Chicken Curry (250g) + Rice (1 cup) + Dal (1 cup) + Salad + Curd (~1200 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (4 rotis), chicken (250g), onion, tomato, ginger-garlic, spices, oil (2 tsp). Rice (1 cup). Dal (1 cup). Salad: cucumber, onion, lemon. Curd (1 cup).

Tip: High protein from chicken and dal. Rice and roti provide ample glycogen replenishment.

Option B: Mutton Biryani (2 cups) + Raita + Boiled Egg (2) + Salad + Papad (~1300 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (3/4 cup raw), mutton (250g), onion, yogurt (3 tbsp), biryani masala, mint, saffron, oil (2 tsp). Raita (1 cup). Eggs (2). Salad: onion, tomato, lemon. Papad (2).

Tip: Mutton is calorie-dense. Eggs add extra protein and healthy fats.

Option C: Butter Chicken (250g) + 4 Naan + Rice (1 cup) + Salad + Lassi (~1400 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken (250g), tomato puree, cashew paste (2 tbsp), cream (3 tbsp), butter (2 tsp), spices. Naan (4, butter 2 tsp). Rice (1 cup). Salad. Lassi (1 glass, full-fat curd).

Tip: Restaurant-style meal made at home with controlled oil. Very high calorie for hard gainers.

Option D: Fish Curry (300g) + Brown Rice (1.5 cups) + Aloo Bharta + 2 Roti + Buttermilk (~1150 kcal)

Ingredients: Fish (300g), mustard, curry leaves, onion, tomato, turmeric, tamarind, mustard oil (2 tsp). Brown rice (1.5 cups). Aloo bharta (potato 2, mustard oil, onion, green chili, salt). Roti (2). Buttermilk (1.5 cups).

Tip: Fish is easily digestible. Multiple carb sources for glycogen loading.

VEGETARIAN — DINNER OPTIONS

Option A: 3 Roti + Matar Paneer (200g) + Dal Makhani (1 cup) + Rice (1/2 cup) + Salad (~980 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (3 rotis), peas (1 cup), paneer (200g), onion, tomato, cream (1 tbsp), butter (1 tsp), spices. Dal makhani (1 cup), butter (1 tsp), cream (1 tbsp). Rice (1/2 cup). Salad.

Tip: Dal makhani is calorie-dense. Paneer provides slow-releasing protein overnight.

Option B: Stuffed Capsicum (3) with Paneer & Potato + 2 Roti + Dal + Curd (~920 kcal)

Ingredients: Capsicum (3 large), paneer (150g), potato (2 medium, boiled), onion, coriander, cumin, salt, cheese (optional, 1 tbsp), baked. Roti (2). Dal (1 cup). Curd (1 cup).

Tip: Baked, not fried. Cheese topping adds extra calories and flavor.

Option C: Mushroom Matar Curry (1.5 cups) + 3 Roti + Rice (1 cup) + Raita + Dessert (~950 kcal)

Ingredients: Mushrooms (2 cups), peas (1 cup), onion, tomato, cream (1 tbsp), spices, oil (1.5 tsp). Roti (3). Rice (1 cup). Raita (1 cup). Dessert: kheer or halwa (small portion).

Tip: Mushrooms provide B vitamins and umami. Dessert helps hit calorie surplus.

Option D: Soya Biryani (2 cups) + Paneer Bhurji (150g) + Raita + Papad + Pickle (~1000 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (3/4 cup raw), soya chunks (1 cup), mixed vegetables, onion, yogurt (2 tbsp), biryani masala, oil (2 tsp). Paneer bhurji (150g paneer, onion, tomato, spices, oil 1 tsp). Raita (1 cup). Papad (2).

Tip: Soya chunks are excellent for muscle building. Paneer bhurji adds extra protein.

NON-VEGETARIAN — DINNER OPTIONS

Option A: Grilled Chicken Breast (250g) + Mashed Potato (2 large) + Steamed Vegetables + Gravy (~950 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken breast (250g), olive oil (1.5 tsp), lemon, herbs, salt, pepper. Potato (2 large, mashed with butter 1 tsp, milk 2 tbsp). Mixed vegetables (1 cup, steamed). Gravy: mushroom/onion gravy (1/2 cup).

Tip: Classic bodybuilder meal. Potato provides fast carbs post-workout.

Option B: Tandoori Chicken (250g) + 3 Roti + Dal (1 cup) + Rice (1/2 cup) + Salad + Curd (~1050 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken (250g), yogurt marinade (2 tbsp), tandoori masala, lemon, salt. Roti (3). Dal (1 cup). Rice (1/2 cup). Salad. Curd (1 cup).

Tip: Tandoori is low-oil cooking. Multiple protein and carb sources for recovery.

Option C: Egg Curry (4 eggs) + 3 Roti + Rice (1 cup) + Aloo Sabzi + Raita (~980 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole eggs (4, boiled), onion, tomato, ginger-garlic, turmeric, coriander, cumin, garam masala, salt, oil (1.5 tsp). Roti (3). Rice (1 cup). Aloo sabzi (potato 2, spices, oil 1 tsp). Raita (1 cup).

Tip: Eggs are the most bioavailable protein source. Budget-friendly muscle meal.

Option D: Mutton Curry (250g) + 3 Roti + Jeera Rice (1 cup) + Dal + Salad + Lassi (~1150 kcal)

Ingredients: Mutton (250g), onion, yogurt (2 tbsp), ginger-garlic, garam masala, turmeric, salt, oil (2 tsp). Roti (3). Jeera rice (1 cup). Dal (1 cup). Salad. Lassi (1 glass).

Tip: Mutton is rich in creatine and iron. Lassi aids protein digestion.

SECTION 4: WEIGHT GAIN (HARD GAINERS)

For individuals with fast metabolism or those recovering from illness/underweight conditions. This plan emphasizes **nutrient-dense, calorie-dense foods** with healthy fats. Typical daily target: **3,000–4,000+ kcal**.

VEGETARIAN — BREAKFAST OPTIONS

Option A: Aloo Paratha (3) + Curd (1.5 cups) + Butter (2 tbsp) + Banana Milkshake (2 glasses) (~1200 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (3 parathas), potato filling (3 medium potatoes), butter (2 tbsp), ghee (2 tsp). Curd (1.5 cups). Milkshake: full-fat milk (2 glasses), banana (3), honey (2 tbsp), almonds (10), dates (5).

Tip: Multiple parathas with butter provide dense calories. Milkshake is liquid calories for easy consumption.

Option B: Soya Chunk Biryani (1.5 cups) + Paneer Bhurji (150g) + Lassi (1.5 glasses) (~1100 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (1/2 cup raw), soya chunks (1 cup), mixed vegetables, onion, yogurt (2 tbsp), biryani masala, oil (2 tsp). Paneer bhurji (150g paneer, onion, tomato, spices, oil 1 tsp). Lassi (1.5 glasses, full-fat curd, sugar).

Tip: Double protein sources. Lassi with sugar adds easy calories.

Option C: Oats (1 cup dry) + Full-Fat Milk (2 cups) + Peanut Butter (2 tbsp) + Whey Protein (1 scoop) + Dates (5) + Walnuts (10) (~1150 kcal)

Ingredients: Rolled oats (1 cup dry), full-fat milk (2 cups), peanut butter (2 tbsp), whey/plant protein (1 scoop), dates (5), walnuts (10 halves), honey (1 tbsp), cinnamon.

Tip: Calorie bomb breakfast. Oats cook in milk for extra creaminess and protein.

Option D: Puri (4) + Aloo Sabzi (2 cups) + Halwa (1 cup) + Lassi (~1300 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (4 puris), oil (for frying, absorbed ~3 tsp). Aloo sabzi (potato 4 medium, onion, tomato, spices, oil 2 tsp). Suji halwa (1 cup, semolina 1/2 cup, ghee 2 tbsp, sugar 3 tbsp, nuts). Lassi (1 glass).

Tip: Traditional high-calorie breakfast. Halwa provides quick energy and fats.

NON-VEGETARIAN — BREAKFAST OPTIONS

Option A: Keema Paratha (3) + Curd (1.5 cups) + Butter + Milkshake (~1300 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (3 parathas), minced chicken/mutton (200g), onion, ginger-garlic, peas, spices, oil (2 tsp), ghee (3 tsp). Curd (1.5 cups). Milkshake: full-fat milk (1.5 glasses), banana (2), dates (3), nuts.

Tip: Keema paratha is calorie-dense. Use full-fat everything for maximum intake.

Option B: 6-Egg Omelette (3 whole + 3 whites) + Cheese (2 slices) + 4 Toast + Butter + Avocado + Milk (~1200 kcal)

Ingredients: Eggs (3 whole, 3 whites), cheese slices (2), butter (2 tsp), bread (4 slices multigrain). Avocado (1 medium). Full-fat milk (1 glass). Onion, tomato, spices for omelette.

Tip: Six eggs provide ~36g protein. Cheese and avocado add healthy fats and calories.

Option C: Chicken Biryani (1.5 cups) + Boiled Egg (2) + Raita + Papad + Sweet Lassi (~1250 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (1/2 cup raw), chicken (150g), biryani masala, yogurt (2 tbsp), oil (2 tsp). Eggs (2). Raita (1 cup). Papad (2). Sweet lassi (1.5 glasses, full-fat curd, sugar 2 tbsp).

Tip: Biryani for breakfast ensures you start with heavy calories. Sweet lassi adds easy liquid calories.

Option D: Fish Fry (300g) + 3 Roti + Dal (1 cup) + Ghee (2 tbsp) + Banana (3) (~1150 kcal)

Ingredients: Fish (300g), turmeric, red chili, salt, mustard oil (3 tsp). Roti (3 whole wheat). Dal (1 cup). Ghee (2 tbsp on roti/dal). Banana (3 medium).

Tip: Fish is nutrient-dense. Ghee on everything boosts calorie count significantly.

VEGETARIAN — LUNCH OPTIONS

Option A: 5 Chapati + Shahi Paneer (250g) + Jeera Rice (1.5 cups) + Dal Makhani (1 cup) + Salad + Raita + Papad + Pickle + Kheer (~1600 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (5 chapatis), paneer (250g), onion, tomato, cashew paste (3 tbsp), cream (3 tbsp), butter (2 tsp), spices. Rice (1.5 cups). Dal makhani (1 cup), butter (2 tsp), cream (2 tbsp). Salad. Raita (1 cup). Papad (2). Kheer (1 cup).

Tip: Ultimate vegetarian bulk meal. Multiple calorie-dense items. Kheer for dessert adds milk carbs and fats.

Option B: Chole Bhature (3 bhature) + Chole (2 cups) + Rice (1 cup) + Raita + Gulab Jamun (2) (~1550 kcal)

Ingredients: Refined flour (3 bhature), oil (for frying, absorbed ~4 tsp). Chickpeas (2 cups cooked), onion, tomato, amchur, garam masala, oil (2 tsp). Rice (1 cup). Raita (1 cup). Gulab jamun (2 pieces).

Tip: Bhature are calorie-dense fried bread. Gulab jamun adds sugar and fat calories.

Option C: Vegetable Pulao (2 cups) + Paneer Butter Masala (250g) + 3 Roti + Dal + Curd + Halwa (~1500 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (3/4 cup raw), mixed vegetables, spices, oil (2 tsp). Paneer (250g), butter (2 tsp), cream (2 tbsp), cashew paste, spices. Roti (3). Dal (1 cup). Curd (1.5 cups). Suji halwa (1 cup).

Tip: Paneer butter masala is extremely calorie-dense. Halwa provides dessert calories.

Option D: Rajma (2 cups) + Rice (2 cups) + Aloo Gobi + 3 Roti + Curd + Ghee (3 tbsp) + Jalebi (2) (~1650 kcal)

Ingredients: Rajma (2 cups cooked), spices, oil (2 tsp). Rice (2 cups cooked). Aloo gobi (potato 2, cauliflower 1 cup, spices, oil 1 tsp). Roti (3). Curd (1.5 cups). Ghee (3 tbsp). Jalebi (2 medium).

Tip: Double rice and rajma portions. Ghee generously. Jalebi adds sugar calories.

NON-VEGETARIAN — LUNCH OPTIONS

Option A: 5 Roti + Butter Chicken (300g) + Rice (1.5 cups) + Dal (1 cup) + Salad + Raita + Papad + Kheer (~1700 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (5 rotis), chicken (300g), tomato puree, cashew paste (3 tbsp), cream (3 tbsp), butter (2 tsp), spices. Rice (1.5 cups). Dal (1 cup). Raita (1 cup). Papad (2). Kheer (1 cup).

Tip: Butter chicken is the ultimate calorie-dense curry. Kheer rounds off the meal.

Option B: Mutton Biryani (2.5 cups) + Raita + Egg Curry (2 eggs) + Salad + Papad + Sweet Lassi + Gulab Jamun (~1750 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (3/4 cup raw), mutton (300g), biryani masala, yogurt (3 tbsp), oil (2.5 tsp). Raita (1 cup). Egg curry (2 eggs, onion, tomato, spices, oil 1 tsp). Salad. Papad (2). Sweet lassi (1.5 glasses). Gulab jamun (2).

Tip: Mutton biryani is extremely calorie-dense. Eggs and dessert push calories higher.

Option C: Chicken Korma (300g) + 4 Naan + Rice (1 cup) + Dal + Salad + Raita + Ice Cream (1 scoop) (~1650 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken (300g), yogurt (3 tbsp), cashew paste (3 tbsp), cream (3 tbsp), coconut (2 tbsp), garam masala, spices, oil (2 tsp). Naan (4, butter 3 tsp). Rice (1 cup). Dal (1 cup). Salad. Raita (1 cup). Ice cream (1 scoop vanilla).

Tip: Korma is rich in nuts and cream. Naan is calorie-dense bread. Ice cream adds dessert calories.

Option D: Fish Curry (400g) + Brown Rice (2 cups) + Aloo Bharta (3 potatoes) + 3 Roti + Ghee + Buttermilk + Payasam (~1600 kcal)

Ingredients: Fish (400g), mustard, curry leaves, onion, tomato, turmeric, tamarind, mustard oil (3 tsp). Brown rice (2 cups cooked). Aloo bharta (potato 3, mustard oil, onion, chili). Roti (3). Ghee (2 tbsp). Buttermilk (1.5 cups). Payasam (1 cup, milk, rice, jaggery, nuts).

Tip: Large fish portion. Multiple carb sources. Payasam is a traditional sweet calorie booster.

VEGETARIAN — DINNER OPTIONS

Option A: 4 Roti + Malai Kofta (200g) + Rice (1 cup) + Dal + Curd + Halwa (~1300 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole wheat flour (4 rotis). Kofta: paneer (150g), potato (2), cream (2 tbsp), cashew paste (2 tbsp), butter (1.5 tsp), spices. Rice (1 cup). Dal (1 cup). Curd (1 cup). Suji halwa (1 cup).

Tip: Malai kofta is deep-fried and creamy — extremely calorie-dense.

Option B: Paneer Biryani (2 cups) + Raita + Papad + Pickle + Kheer (~1200 kcal)

Ingredients: Basmati rice (3/4 cup raw), paneer (200g), mixed vegetables, onion, yogurt (2 tbsp), biryani masala, oil (2 tsp). Raita (1 cup). Papad (2). Kheer (1 cup).

Tip: Paneer biryani is a complete meal. Kheer adds milk-based dessert calories.

Option C: Stuffed Naan (2) with Paneer + Dal Makhani (1.5 cups) + Rice + Salad + Lassi + Jalebi (~1400 kcal)

Ingredients: Naan (2, stuffed with paneer 150g, butter 2 tsp). Dal makhani (1.5 cups), butter (2 tsp), cream (2 tbsp). Rice (1 cup). Salad. Lassi (1.5 glasses). Jalebi (2).

Tip: Stuffed naan is calorie-dense. Dal makhani with cream and butter is a hard gainer's friend.

Option D: Vegetable Korma (1.5 cups) + 4 Roti + Rice (1 cup) + Curd + Ghee + Dessert (~1250 kcal)

Ingredients: Mixed vegetables (2 cups), coconut paste (3 tbsp), cashew paste (2 tbsp), cream (2 tbsp), spices, oil (2 tsp). Roti (4). Rice (1 cup). Curd (1.5 cups). Ghee (2 tbsp). Dessert: halwa or kheer (1 cup).

Tip: Coconut and cashew make korma rich in healthy fats. Dessert ensures surplus.

NON-VEGETARIAN — DINNER OPTIONS

Option A: Tandoori Chicken (300g) + 4 Roti + Butter Naan (1) + Dal + Rice + Salad + Raita + Kheer (~1450 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken (300g), yogurt marinade (3 tbsp), tandoori masala, lemon, salt. Roti (4). Butter naan (1, butter 1.5 tsp). Dal (1 cup). Rice (1 cup). Salad. Raita (1 cup). Kheer (1 cup).

Tip: Tandoori is relatively lean but large portions and sides push calories.

Option B: Mutton Curry (300g) + 4 Roti + Jeera Rice (1.5 cups) + Dal + Papad + Sweet Lassi + Gulab Jamun (~1550 kcal)

Ingredients: Mutton (300g), onion, yogurt (3 tbsp), ginger-garlic, garam masala, spices, oil (2.5 tsp). Roti (4). Jeera rice (1.5 cups). Dal (1 cup). Papad (2). Sweet lassi (1.5 glasses). Gulab jamun (2).

Tip: Mutton is naturally calorie-dense. Sweet lassi and gulab jamun add significant sugar calories.

Option C: Chicken Tikka Masala (300g) + 3 Naan + Rice (1 cup) + Dal + Salad + Ice Cream (~1500 kcal)

Ingredients: Chicken (300g), tomato puree, cashew paste (3 tbsp), cream (3 tbsp), butter (2 tsp), tikka masala spices. Naan (3, butter 2 tsp). Rice (1 cup). Dal (1 cup). Salad. Ice cream (1 scoop).

Tip: Tikka masala gravy is rich in cream and nuts. Naan is calorie-dense flatbread.

Option D: Egg Curry (5 eggs) + 4 Roti + Rice (1.5 cups) + Aloo Dum + Raita + Dessert (~1350 kcal)

Ingredients: Whole eggs (5, boiled), onion, tomato, ginger-garlic, turmeric, coriander, cumin, garam masala, salt, oil (2 tsp). Roti (4). Rice (1.5 cups). Aloo dum (potato 3, spices, oil 1.5 tsp). Raita (1 cup). Dessert (1 cup halwa/kheer).

Tip: Five eggs provide ~30g protein. Aloo dum and dessert add carb and fat calories.

SECTION 5: HEALTHY SNACKS & BEVERAGES

Snacks bridge the gap between meals and prevent overeating. Choose snacks based on your goal.

Snack / Beverage	Portion	Calories	Best For
Roasted Makhana (Fox Nuts)	1 cup	150 kcal	High fiber, low calorie. Good for weight loss.
Sprouted Chana Chaat	1 bowl	180 kcal	Protein and fiber rich. Good for maintenance/muscle.
Peanut Chikki (Homemade, jaggery-based)	2 pieces	220 kcal	Energy dense. Good for weight gain.
Fruit Bowl with Nuts	1 bowl + 10 almonds	250 kcal	Natural sugars + healthy fats. Universal snack.
Paneer Tikka (3-4 pieces)	100g paneer	280 kcal	High protein. Muscle gain/weight maintenance.
Boiled Eggs (2)	2 whole eggs	140 kcal	Complete protein. Any goal.
Chicken Salad	150g chicken	320 kcal	High protein, low carb. Weight loss/muscle.
Suji Upma (1 bowl)	1 cup	200 kcal	Complex carbs. Maintenance/weight gain.
Dry Fruit Laddu (Homemade)	2 small	300 kcal	Calorie-dense. Weight gain.
Cucumber & Carrot Sticks with Hummus	1 cup veg + 3 tbsp hummus	180 kcal	Fiber and protein. Weight loss.
Masala Chai (with milk & sugar)	1 cup	120 kcal	Comfort beverage. Limit sugar for weight loss.
Green Tea / Black Coffee	1 cup	5 kcal	Zero-calorie. Metabolism boost. Weight loss.
Buttermilk (Chaas)	1 glass	80 kcal	Probiotic, hydrating. Any goal.
Fresh Coconut Water	1 glass	45 kcal	Electrolytes. Post-workout. Any goal.
Badam Milk (Full-fat)	1 glass	250 kcal	Protein + healthy fats. Weight gain/muscle.

SECTION 6: DIET MYTHS & FACTS

Including the truth about Diet Sodas and common Indian diet misconceptions.

MYTH: DIET SODA HELPS YOU LOSE WEIGHT

FACT: Diet sodas contain zero calories but use artificial sweeteners (aspartame, sucralose, acesulfame-K). Research shows they may increase cravings for sweet foods, disrupt gut microbiome, and potentially lead to weight gain over time by altering insulin response. They do not provide nutrition and may increase risk of metabolic syndrome. Water, buttermilk, or coconut water are superior choices.

MYTH: DESI GHEE MAKES YOU FAT

FACT: Pure cow ghee contains short-chain fatty acids (butyrate) that support gut health and metabolism. In moderate amounts (1-2 tsp/day), ghee aids absorption of fat-soluble vitamins (A, D, E, K). It has a high smoke point making it safer for Indian cooking than refined oils. Excessive consumption of any fat leads to weight gain — the issue is quantity, not ghee itself.

MYTH: CARBS AT NIGHT CAUSE WEIGHT GAIN

FACT: Total daily calorie balance matters more than meal timing. However, heavy carbs at night may cause bloating and poor sleep quality for some. For muscle gain, nighttime carbs can aid recovery. For weight loss, shift carbs to earlier meals and focus on protein + vegetables at dinner.

MYTH: EGG YOLKS ARE UNHEALTHY

FACT: Egg yolks contain choline, vitamin D, B12, and healthy fats. Dietary cholesterol has minimal impact on blood cholesterol for most people. Whole eggs are one of the most bioavailable protein sources. Limiting yolks is only necessary for those with specific genetic cholesterol disorders.

MYTH: GREEN TEA ALONE BURNS FAT

FACT: Green tea contains catechins (EGCG) and caffeine that may slightly boost metabolism (3-4% increase), but it cannot replace a calorie deficit or exercise. It is a helpful adjunct, not a magic solution. Drinking 2-3 cups daily is safe and may support overall health.

MYTH: PROTEIN DAMAGES KIDNEYS

FACT: For healthy individuals, high protein intake (up to 2g/kg bodyweight) does not harm kidney function. Those with pre-existing kidney disease should monitor protein under medical supervision. Protein is essential for muscle repair, hormone production, and immune function.

MYTH: FRUIT JUICE IS AS HEALTHY AS WHOLE FRUIT

FACT: Juicing removes fiber and concentrates sugars. A glass of orange juice has the sugar of 3-4 oranges without the satiety. Whole fruits provide fiber that slows sugar absorption. Eat fruits whole; limit juice to occasional small servings.

MYTH: SPICY FOOD BURNS MORE CALORIES

FACT: Capsaicin (in chili) has a mild thermogenic effect, increasing calorie burn by approximately 10-20 kcal per meal. This is negligible compared to total daily expenditure. Spicy food can increase satiety and water intake, which may indirectly help weight management.

MYTH: SKIPPING MEALS SPEEDS UP WEIGHT LOSS

FACT: Skipping meals often leads to overeating later, muscle loss, and metabolic slowdown. Consistent meal timing with controlled portions is more effective. Intermittent fasting works for some, but it is about controlling the eating window, not skipping nutrition.

MYTH: DIET CHOLESTEROL = BLOOD CHOLESTEROL

FACT: For approximately 75% of people, dietary cholesterol has minimal impact on blood cholesterol levels. The liver produces cholesterol endogenously. Saturated and trans fats have a greater impact on LDL cholesterol than dietary cholesterol from eggs or shellfish.

SECTION 7: GENERAL TIPS FOR SUCCESS

Portion Control is Key: Even healthy Indian food can be calorie-dense. Use smaller plates and measure rice/roti portions.

Cook at Home: Restaurant Indian food is often loaded with butter, cream, and oil. Home cooking lets you control ingredients.

Use Whole Grains: Replace white rice with brown/red rice; use whole wheat, jowar, bajra, or ragi rotis instead of refined flour.

Protein at Every Meal: Ensure each meal has a protein source — dal, paneer, eggs, chicken, fish, or soya.

Vegetables are Free: Fill half your plate with vegetables. They add volume, fiber, and micronutrients with minimal calories.

Limit Fried Foods: Samosas, pakoras, and pooris are occasional treats, not daily staples. Air-fry or bake when possible.

Stay Hydrated: Drink 3-4 liters of water daily. Thirst is often mistaken for hunger. Include buttermilk and coconut water.

Spice Smartly: Turmeric, cumin, coriander, fenugreek, and ginger have anti-inflammatory and digestive benefits.

Plan Ahead: Prep sprouts, boiled eggs, and chopped vegetables on Sunday for the week. This prevents unhealthy impulse eating.

Read Labels: Many packaged Indian snacks (bhujia, mixture) are high in trans fats and sodium. Check nutrition labels.

Don't Drink Calories: Avoid sugary lassis, sodas, and fruit juices. Choose water, black coffee, green tea, or buttermilk.

Sleep Matters: Poor sleep increases ghrelin (hunger hormone) and decreases leptin (satiety hormone). Aim for 7-8 hours.

Consistency Over Perfection: One cheat meal won't ruin progress. One healthy meal won't transform you. Consistency wins.

Track Your Intake: Use apps like MyFitnessPal or HealthifyMe for 2-4 weeks to understand your actual eating patterns.

Respect Your Body Type: Ectomorphs (hard gainers) need more carbs and fats. Endomorphs (easy gainers) need stricter portion control. Mesomorphs have more flexibility.

Disclaimer: This guide is for educational purposes only. Individual nutritional needs vary based on age, gender, activity level, medical conditions, and body composition. Consult a registered dietitian or physician before making significant dietary changes, especially if you have diabetes, kidney disease, heart conditions, or eating disorders.